

Discussion Guide: AI in the Classroom

Honest AI conversations with students of any age

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Questions to bring into class, and a framework for talking about AI honestly with students of any age.

Why This Guide Exists

Your students are already using AI. The question is whether they are using it thoughtfully or reflexively. This guide helps you start the conversations that make the difference.

The Framework: Four Questions

What is it? Understanding - What does this tool actually do? How does it work? What is it not?

Who made it and why? Power - Who built this, who benefits, what decisions were made? What voices are missing?

What can go wrong? Risk - Where does it fail, who does it harm, what are the edge cases?

What do I do with it? Agency - How do I use this as a tool that serves my goals, rather than shapes them?

Discussion Questions by Level

For students new to AI:

- Have you used AI before? What did you use it for?
- What do you think AI is? What do you think it is not?
- If AI helped you write something, who gets credit for it?

For students with some AI experience:

- When is it okay to use AI for schoolwork? Where is the line?
- What is the difference between AI helping you learn and doing the learning for you?
- Have you ever caught AI being wrong? What did you do?
- If AI can do this assignment, what is this assignment actually for?

For deeper discussions:

- Whose knowledge, values, and perspectives are baked into these tools?
- Who does not have access to these tools, and what does that mean?

- What happens to human skill when we outsource practice to AI?
- What is something AI should never be used for in education? Why?

Teaching Moves That Work

Show, do not tell

Use AI live in class. Ask it a question. Show the output. Ask students: Is this right? How would we check?

Compare outputs

Have groups ask the same question in different ways. Compare the answers. What changed? Why?

The verification challenge

Give students an AI-generated text with 3 errors embedded. Their job: find them all.

The argument for both sides

Ask AI to argue FOR and AGAINST a position students are studying. Then ask: which argument is stronger, and what is missing?

A Note on Your Own Use

The most powerful thing you can do is be honest about how you use AI - in lesson planning, feedback writing, your own research. Students notice the gap between what adults say and what they do. Close the gap.